

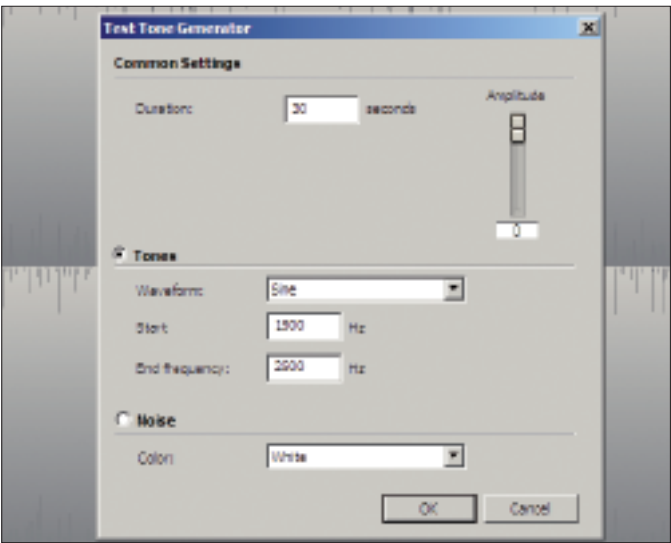
Slide Show. Alternatively, start up Nero Vision, go to Make Slide Show. Click on either DVD, VCD, Super VCD or Mini DVD depending on your choice. Drag and drop photos in the editor. Add music and / or commentary. You can import pictures directly from a digital camera attached to the computer, or add images from a website or image hosting account. Also set the transitions. There're few options available, but they're effective. Once the photos are arranged in the right order, you can export the slideshow as a video instead of burning the slideshow onto some medium. Click on Export, then select the file type and click on Export. For this, AVI, MPEG and WMV formats are supported. You can also export the slideshow to a camcorder connected to the computer. To burn a DVD, click Next to add titles. Click Next again to set up the DVD menu, add chapters and configure the DVD. The next screen gives you a preview of the DVD, as it will appear on your television. Click on Next, then Burn.

Using pause detection in Nero WaveEditor

If you have a single sound file of an entire album, Nero WaveEditor can recognise separate tracks in the song using the pause detection feature. Once these pauses are recognised, either the pauses can be deleted from the file, or the file can be separated into individual tracks. To delete the pauses from the file, Go to Edit > Pause Detection > Delete Pauses. To mark portions on either side of the pause, go to Edit > Pause Detection > Insert Track Splits. This allows you to extract individual tracks from the file. To get rid of pauses, go to Edit > Pause Detection > Insert Track Splits and Delete Pauses. This introduces markers so that individual tracks can still be worked on.

Inserting a test signal in Nero WaveEditor

A test signal is used to test if the sound for the presentation or video is working properly while screening it before an audience. It is invariably placed at the beginning of the presentation or video. To insert a test



The tone generator

signal in Nero WaveEditor, select the entire sound file, go to Edit > Insert Test Signal. In the test tone generator dialogue, select a duration for the test signal. The default is 30 seconds. There are three different waveforms available – sine, sawtooth and square. These are just different ways of generating the tone. The start and end frequency generates a sweep either increasing or decreasing in frequency across the duration of the test signal. To generate a tone of constant frequency, keep the values the same across both these fields. Click on OK, the test signal will be inserted at the beginning of the selection.

Creating an image file

An Image file is a package of data that can be transferred in portable media like an external hard drive or a USB drive. An image file can be handled like a zip file, and can be loaded as a disk on the computer using a CD / DVD Drive emulator. This feature can be particularly useful in computers without a CD / DVD writer, where a package can be made for writing to a disc later on, or from another

computer. In Nero Express, after adding files to be burned, set the Current Recorder to Image Recorder [DVD]. Select a disc name, and click on burn. An image file will be created on your system. You also have the option of burning image files from other Nero applications like

Nero Vision.

Saving a CD / DVD as an image file

You can save CDs and DVDs that are not copy-protected, as an image file on your computer. This image file can be used to burn multiple copies, archive important data, save media from physical corruption and load data onto emulators while keeping the drive free. Using this feature on copyrighted material is illegal, even if the data is not copy protected. Extend the side panel, go to Copy Data Track. Select a track from the list in the dialogue that appears. Then click on Next. The image can be saved as an NRG or an ISO file. Select a destination and click on Save.

DJ with Nero

Nero 9 comes with a complete DJ simulator. Start up Nero SoundTrax, then



DJing with Nero

go to Insert > ScratchBox clip. This brings up the ScratchBox dialogue, which has two turntables. You can mix tracks, tweak tracks, add effects, work with loops and scratch. While the setup can be used for DJing live, (there is no way to quickly load files though), the primary purpose is to remix tracks and save them.

Changing the audio distribution with SoundTrax

Nero SoundTrax automatically detects the numbers of speakers connected to the system. This works for 2, 2.1, 4.1, 5.1 and 7.1 systems. The numbers signify the speakers connected to your system plus the sub-woofer. The area below Assignable Effects with the title bar of the file you are working with, has a pan slider. Here, the number of speakers connected to the system are represented spatially, and a green dot can be moved around the square to denote the origin of the sound.

Enabling Quiet Disk in ShowTime

Although no one is likely to use Nero ShowTime as their default audio CD player, we wish other software would include thoughtful features like this. Quiet Disk playback silences the sound from the CD / DVD drive as much as possible while playing back songs from the drive. To enable this feature in ShowTime, go to Options > Quiet Disk Playback > Enable Quiet Disk Playback. To navigate to the Options menu across software in the Nero 9 suite, click on the hammer icon.

Setting a drive speed using DriveSpeed

Nero DriveSpeed is an application for

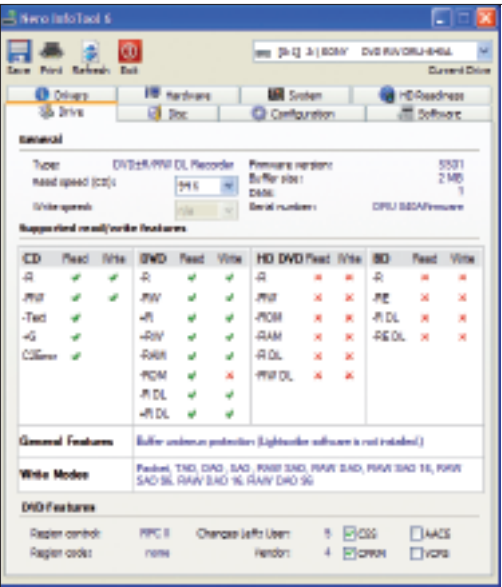
tweaking the read speeds of your disk drive. This can be used for a number of purposes, including reducing the noise your drive makes and improving read quality of the audio CDs. A slower drive speed reduces noise while increasing the accuracy of the reads. A higher drive speed is used for rapid file access, especially in applications such as games. There is also an option to reduce the spin down time of the disk in the drive. However, this does not have any advantage for the newer drives. In earlier drives, this helps by ejecting the disk after a read operation. This feature is used to control how long the disk continues to spin inside the drive after the read operation has been stopped.

Disabling disk ejection

If after burning a disk, you want to check your data once, you can save time by disabling disk ejection after burning. This also saves you the inconvenience of closing the tray as soon as it is ejected. In Nero Express, extend the side panel, go to Options > Expert Features then select the Do not eject the disk after the burn is complete check box.

Using InfoTool

Nero InfoTool is a useful little application that can summarise all the hardware and software features and specifications in your computer. The results can be used to analyse the multimedia capabilities of your system, as well as the points where upgrades are necessary to suit your



Nero InfoTool analysing the computer

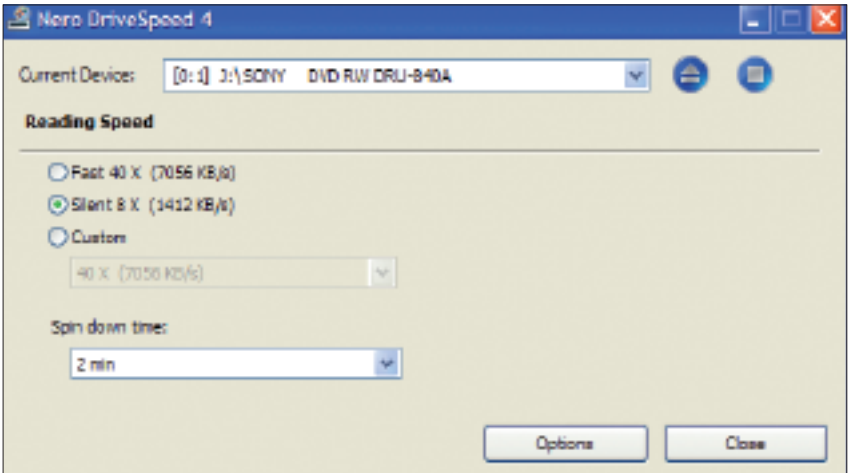
requirements. The tool lists the drivers, the audio and video codecs installed, the features of the drive and the nature of the disk in the drive. Before using this tool, close all programs, put in a blank CD / DVD in the available drives and disable any drive emulators that are running. Start Nero InfoTool, go to Nero9 > Extra > Nero InfoTool or Nero9 > Nero Toolkit > Nero InfoTool depending on your installation. The application will analyse the computer, and show you the results.

Benchmarking your CD / DVDs

You can run advanced quality tests on your storage medium to check how well preserved the files are. While the benchmark runs for blank media as well, the disk quality test runs only for media with files on them. Run Nero DiscSpeed then go to Benchmark > Start or Disc Quality > Start. You can choose how thorough the tests are. The light test checks only specific points of data on the disk, whereas the thorough test scans through all the tracks on the disk.

Overburning your disks

Overburning is used to burn more than the normal amount of data onto a disk. The extra space used is the lead out portion of the disk, where about a minute and a half of extra music can be burnt (about 5 to 10 MB in a CD). Using overburning for any other purpose apart from music is too risky as there is a



Adjusting the drive speed